

First 15 · Decision Guide

Keep this in the door pocket.

The 90-second triage

1

Name it in one sentence
Specific, not urgent. "Rear right is at 61, spec is 80." You can't size up a vague problem, and you can't escalate one either.

2

Run the four triggers
Risk · Custody · Promise · Ambiguity. Any single yes means someone else needs to know.

3

Pick one of three
Fix it, Flag it, or Note it. Still deciding after ninety seconds? That itself is a Flag.

FIX
I can resolve this myself, right now, safely, and within policy.

FLAG
Someone else has the authority, information, or resources. Tell them now, completely, and keep working.

NOTE
Doesn't change today's plan, but it goes on the record.

The four triggers

Any one of these makes it a Flag.

RISK	Roadworthiness, load security, or anyone's physical safety — yours, the public's, a customer's.
CUSTODY	Cold chain, signature required, controlled goods, anything sealed or carrying a temperature indicator.
PROMISE	A committed window or service level you now can't reliably make. The trigger is the risk, not the confirmed failure.
AMBIGUITY	Information you can't resolve with what you've got, where being wrong has a cost. 80% sure is ambiguity.

The order of precedence

SAFETY	A gate, not a trade-off. Resolve it before the van moves.
SERVICE	Protect the promise you can keep. Renegotiate the one you can't — early.
TIME	The variable you manage, not the one you protect.

A slow leak is a Flag.
A cold-morning pressure variance is a Note.
The tell is change, not the number.

A customer can tell you their preference. They can't authorise you to enter, sign on their behalf, or promise you an animal's behaviour.

Escalation — four fields, thirty seconds

CONDITION	IDENTIFIER	REQUEST	DEADLINE
What is true, in one specific sentence.	Which one. Van, tracking number, stop, route.	What you need from them, specifically.	By when — and what happens if not.

[Route] — [condition]. [Identifier]. Need [request]. By [deadline].

"Two-fourteen — cold-chain tote, indicator tripped to red. Tote 88-C. Need a replacement or a re-route. Before 8:00 — clinic window closes at 9:30."

The deadline is the field people skip and the one that costs most. Without it, everything on a coordinator's board looks equally urgent.

Five inspection zones

- Tires and pressure** — All four, written down. Below spec, or moved since your last reading.
- Under the van** — Ten seconds. Anything wet that wasn't there is a Flag.
- Cargo and securement** — Stable under hard braking. Cold chain at the front, never buried.
- Lights and glass** — Perimeter walk with the lights on. Roadside-inspection items are Flags.
- Cab and handheld** — Seat, mirrors, belt. Then read the manifest for exceptions before route.

Exceptions change the route. The route never changes the exceptions.